Yeonchan Kang

Ph.D. student in Economics, Sungkyunkwan University

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Education

Sungkyunkwan University 2026–present
Ph.D. student in Economics

Sungkyunkwan University 2026
M.A. in Economics
Thesis: "Factor Timing Using Characteristic State Similarity" · Advisor: Doojin Ryu

Inha University 2024
B.S. in Industrial Engineering
Capstone Design Project: "Machine Learning Interpretability in Finance"

Research Interests

Commercial Real Estate · Housing Markets · Asset Pricing · Big Data & Machine Learning

Publications

[8] Kang, Y., & Ryu, D. (2026). "One City, Multiple Markets: District-Specific Housing Valuations Using Interpretable Machine Learning." *Spatial Economic Analysis*. Online. DOI: 10.1080/17421772.2026.2761314.

[7] **Kang, Y., & Ryu, D. (2026). "Factor Timing with Characteristic-State Similarity." *Journal of Portfolio Management*. Online. DOI: 10.3905/jpm.2026.088. (SSCI)**
Expanded from the M.A. thesis "Factor Timing Using Characteristic State Similarity."
Best Paper Award, Korean Financial Management Association (2025), awarded under the title "Dynamic Factor Timing."

[6] Kang, Y., & Ryu, D. (2026). "Market-specific confirmation horizons in momentum turning-point strategies." *Applied Economics*. Online. DOI: 10.1080/00036846.2026.2737829. (SSCI)

[5] Kang, Y., & Ryu, D. (2026). "Time-series momentum and market timing in Bitcoin." *Risk Management*, 28, 54. DOI: 10.1057/s41283-026-00234-7. (SSCI)

[4] Kang, H., Kang, Y., Ryu, D., & Webb, R. I. (2026). "Bitcoin Forecasting with Machine Learning and On-Chain Information." *Investment Analysts Journal*. DOI: 10.1080/10293523.2026.2616575. (SSCI)

[3] Kang, Y., Ryu, D., & Webb, R. I. (2026). "Uncertainty Indicators as Key Predictors of Oil Volatility: An Interpretable Machine Learning Approach." *Computational Economics*. DOI: 10.1007/s10614-025-11299-z. (SSCI)

[2] Kang, Y., Ryu, D., & Webb, R. I. (2025). "How Well Do Machine Learning Models in Finance Work?" *Financial Innovation*, 11. DOI: 10.1186/s40854-025-00870-0. (SSCI)
Expanded from the Inha University B.S. capstone project "Machine Learning Interpretability in Finance."

[1] Bang, J., Kang, Y., & Ryu, D. (2024). "Potential Pricing Factors in the Korean Market." *Finance Research Letters*, 67. DOI: 10.1016/j.frl.2024.105946. (SSCI)

Other Publication

[1] Kang, Y., & Ryu, D. (2023). "Trends of Machine Learning Application in Finance." *Korean Journal of Financial Engineering*. DOI: 10.35527/kfedoi.2023.22.3.006.

Work in Progress

[1] "Representing Location in House-Price Prediction: Hexagonal Spatial Encodings and Out-of-Sample Performance"
[2] "Private Education Capitalization in Seoul Housing and Jeonse Markets"
[3] "Temporal Demand Structure and Shopping District Rent Capitalization"

Awards & Fellowships

Korean Finance Association – Kiwoom Securities Ph.D. Fellowship 2026–2027
BK21 Fellowship, Sungkyunkwan University, Ph.D. Program 2026–2027
Best Paper Award, Korean Financial Management Association 2025
Awarded for "Dynamic Factor Timing."
BK21 Fellowship, Sungkyunkwan University, Master's Program 2024–2025

Conference Presentations

2026 Korea's Allied Economic Associations Annual Meeting
2025 Korean Financial Management Association Annual Conference, Asia-Pacific Association of Finance International Conference, SERI International Conference, Seoul Workshop on Empirical Finance
2024 Korean Financial Management Association Annual Conference, SERI International Conference, Korea's Allied Economic Associations Annual Meeting

Teaching Assistant Experience

Graduate: Market Microstructure (2025); Financial Engineering and Theory of Finance (2024).
Undergraduate (English-taught): Risk and Portfolio Management (2026); Asset Pricing (2025); Financial Derivatives and Financial Economics (2024).

Referee Service

Journal of Multinational Financial Management, *Emerging Markets Review*, *Financial Innovation*

Skills

Econometrics & Spatial Analysis: Panel data, hedonic pricing, spatial feature engineering
Machine Learning: Tree ensembles (random forests, XGBoost), model interpretability (SHAP, permutation importance, partial dependence)
Forecasting & Evaluation: Financial forecasting, rolling-window and out-of-sample evaluation
Computing: R (fixest, tidyverse), Python (scikit-learn, PyTorch), SQL (DuckDB), Git, LaTeX

Languages

Korean (native) · English (proficient)

Military Service

Republic of Korea Army 2019–2021
CBRN Specialist, Division Artillery Brigade Headquarters and Headquarters Battery
Capital Mechanized Infantry Division, Artillery Brigade

References

Doojin Ryu
Professor of Economics, Sungkyunkwan University

Robert I. Webb
Professor of Finance, University of Virginia